EJ FOX



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PROFILE

Design engineer and creative technologist who does good work under pressure. I turn complicated information into interactive graphics people can actually read, and I have fun doing it. The work mixes journalistic curiosity with an addiction to trying new things. That has included NBC's election-night graphics and experimental interfaces for embeddings. I want to make things no one has seen before, with smart, kind people.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Code: JavaScript, Python, Node.js, Vue, React, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, SQL

Graphics: D3, Observable Plot, Three.js, WebGL, Canvas, SVG, TopoJSON

AI/ML: LLM APIs, embedding visualization, context management, vector databases, prompt engineering, tool usage, alternative interfaces

Design & Motion: Illustrator, Photoshop, Final Cut Pro, After Effects, Principle, Figma, Animation (GSAP, Anime.js)

Methods: Rapid prototyping, joy-driven development, component systems, public documentation, performance optimization, video demos

EXPERIENCE

Lenfest AI Fellow

Arizona State University NEWSWELL | 2025 - 2026

The Lenfest Institute's AI Collaborative and Fellowship Program, hosted at ASU and supported by OpenAI and Microsoft

- Built a tool that uses AI to lay out the ads and stories in hyperlocal print newspapers
- Gave an Ignite talk on it at ASU's National Journalism + AI Accelerator in January 2026
- Demoed it to OpenAI, Microsoft, ProPublica and the Boston Globe on the program's demo day

Design Engineer & Creative Technologist

Independent Consultant | 2019 - Present

Select Clients: GitHub • NBC News • CBS News • Washington Post • New York Times • Carnegie Mellon • Stamen

- I take the tight-deadline projects, the ones that need short sprints and user testing. Especially the things no one has done before
- For CBS News, helped prototype their broadcast touchscreen app. For the New York Times, an analysis of newspaper front pages. With the geniuses at Stamen, geographic visualizations.
- I sit between the design and engineering teams and work in whatever stack the client already has, whether that is a brand-new startup or a big enterprise with its own process
- I work in public whenever I can. That means 50+ Observable notebooks, plus YouTube livestreams and blog posts about work in progress, experiments and how I do things.

Founder

Room 302 Studio | 2023 - Present

Select Clients: The Associated Press • Wildlife Conservation Society • Earth Genome

- A prototyping shop for new kinds of data visualization and analysis, on tight deadlines

- Built a studio manager on top of an LLM, the studio's 'AI team member'
- We turn rough ideas into demos polished enough for a client to show their own leadership or take to a funder
- Backed up the Associated Press team on its 2024 election coverage. The work was nominated for a Webby.
- Helped the Wildlife Conservation Society map and tell the story of coral reefs that are resisting climate change

Contractor

Stamen Design | 2020 - 2022

- Made geographic visualizations with the Stamen team

Senior Interactive Graphics Specialist

NBC News | 2016 - 2019

- Lead designer and co-builder of the 2018 relaunch of the election-night Big Board, with Michael Small and the NBC News Digital teams. The New York Times called it "newly juiced-up." It is still in use today.

Graphics Editor

Vocativ | 2014 - 2016

- Took the desk from five graphics a month to five a day, 20x, through automation
- Led the winning Knight Foundation grant pitch for Dataproofer, a data-validation tool
- Gave reporters a visualization platform they could use without us, made the visualization templates, and ran the daily breaking-news graphics

Early Career

- *GitHub (2013)*: Freelanced with the GitHub team on the "State of the Octoverse" site and its visualizations
- *Visual.ly (2011)*: On the core team that built one of the first platforms to offer visualization as a service

PROJECTS

Subway Builder · Borough Studio, 2025 - 2026. A subway simulation game. Development credit. Got the desktop build out the door, then the Steam release in July 2026.

Decision Desk HQ, 2025 - 2026. Design and engineering on the tools broadcasters use to show election results

Global Energy Ownership Tracker · Global Energy Monitor, 2025 - 2026. An explorer of which companies own which energy assets, with ownership trees, embeddable cards and a screener

Paramilitary Leaks, 2025. An explorer and visualizations for 200 GB of leaked militia chats. Micah Lee credited the work in his reporting.

NYPD misconduct network · WNYC/Gothamist, 2021. Network analysis of civilian complaint records for an investigation into clusters of officers accused of misconduct over and over

Climate TRACE · Earthrise Media, 2022. Maps and data exploration of emitting assets around the world

Ukraine grain · Earth Genome, 2022 - 2023. Scrollytelling data story on global food security

COVIDcast · Carnegie Mellon University Delphi, 2020. Visualization prototypes for the public COVID-19 indicators, as a contributor from July to September 2020

Election simulator · Washington Post Opinions, 2019 - 2020. Engineering on an interactive simulator built on David Byler's election model

Dark-money map · Mother Jones, 2012. Co-author of an interactive map of the super PAC and dark-money universe